

Name: _____ Partner: _____ Period: _____

Part A — Satellite Orbit

A satellite orbits Earth in a circular orbit of radius 8000 km, centered at Earth's center (the origin). It starts at (8000, 0) and travels counterclockwise, completing one full orbit in 2 hours. Using t in hours, the angle after t hours is πt radians.

Tier R — Remediate

A1. Write parametric equations $x(t)$ and $y(t)$ for the satellite's position at time t hours.

$$x(t) = 8000 \cos(\pi t) \quad y(t) = 8000 \sin(\pi t)$$

A2. Complete the table.

t (hours)	$x(t)$ (km)	$y(t)$ (km)	Position (x, y)
0	8000	0	(8000, 0)
0.5	0	8000	(0, 8000)
1	-8000	0	(-8000, 0)
1.5	0	-8000	(0, -8000)
2	8000	0	(8000, 0)

Tier A — Approaching Proficiency

A3. At what time t is the satellite directly above the origin on the north side ($x = 0, y > 0$)?

Set $x(t) = 8000 \cos(\pi t) = 0$: $\cos(\pi t) = 0$, so $\pi t = \pi/2$, giving $t = 1/2$ hour. At $t = 0.5$: $y(0.5) = 8000 \sin(\pi/2) = 8000 \text{ km} > 0$. **The satellite is directly north of the origin at $t = 0.5$ hours.**

A4. Clockwise orbit: replace t with $-t$:

$$x(t) = 8000 \cos(-\pi t) = 8000 \cos(\pi t) \quad (\text{same})$$

$$y(t) = 8000 \sin(-\pi t) = -8000 \sin(\pi t)$$

Teacher Note

A3 is a good cold-call opportunity. A4 reinforces the key even/odd identity: $\cos(-\theta) = \cos \theta$ and $\sin(-\theta) = -\sin \theta$.

Part B — Rover Path

A rover travels in a straight line from base camp at $(-3, 2)$ to a sample site at $(5, -2)$.

Tier E — Extension

B1. Parametric equations for $0 \leq t \leq 1$:

$$x(t) = -3 + (5 - (-3))t = -3 + 8t$$

$$y(t) = 2 + (-2 - 2)t = 2 - 4t$$

B2. Positions:

At $t = 0.25$: $x = -3 + 8(0.25) = -1$, $y = 2 - 4(0.25) = 1$. Position: $(-1, 1)$.

At $t = 0.75$: $x = -3 + 8(0.75) = 3$, $y = 2 - 4(0.75) = -1$. Position: $(3, -1)$.

B3. Rover crosses x -axis when $y(t) = 0$:

$$2 - 4t = 0 \Rightarrow t = 1/2.$$

At $t = 1/2$: $x(1/2) = -3 + 8(1/2) = 1$.

The rover crosses the x -axis at the point $(1, 0)$, when $t = 0.5$.

Teacher Note

B2–B3 preview the idea that the parameter t can be solved for algebraically (EK 4.4.A.3). Connect to Lesson 4.1’s skill of solving for t to find when a curve hits a target coordinate.